

Seasonal Merchandising Guidelines

Document: MRG-POL-103 | Version: v1.0 | Effective: March 1, 2026 | Last reviewed: February 15, 2026

Purpose

Seasonal items follow predictable annual demand cycles that a forecasting model will generally detect on its own from historical sales patterns. This policy governs how reorder behavior should change at the edges of each season, which a demand forecast alone does not capture.

Seasonal Windows

Category / Subset	Season Window	Build-up Starts	Draw-down Starts
Winter Apparel & Outerwear	Oct 1 - Feb 28	3 weeks before (Sep 10)	2 weeks before end (Feb 14)
Summer Apparel & Accessories	Apr 1 - Aug 31	3 weeks before (Mar 11)	2 weeks before end (Aug 17)
Back-to-School (subset: 39,42,43,44,46,48,50)	Aug 1 - Sep 15	3 weeks before (Jul 11)	1 week before end (Sep 8)
Holiday (subset: 26, 38)	Nov 1 - Dec 31	3 weeks before (Oct 11)	1 week before end (Dec 24)

Build-up and Draw-down Rules

Build-up: beginning on the build-up start date, increase target safety stock to 1.5x the standard calculation from MRG-POL-104 for items in that season's category, subject to store capacity limits in MRG-REF-002.

Draw-down: beginning on the draw-down start date, halt new reorders for that season's core items even if short-term forecasted demand remains positive, in order to avoid carrying unsold seasonal inventory into the off-season. Existing on-hand stock should be sold through, not replenished.

Related documents: MRG-REF-001, MRG-POL-101 (Restocking and Reorder Policy), MRG-POL-104 (Supplier Lead Time and Safety Stock Policy)